

NEXTGEN RESEARCH DUEL

NextGen Research Duel (NRD) is a category intended to test your research, critical thinking, and science inquisitive skills. It provokes participants to dig deeper beyond superficial understanding, challenging them to question, dissect, and reinterpret concepts with the heart of a real researcher or scientist. NRD is not just about learning more about a topic but also about learning how to recognize gaps, suggest remedies, and imagine the future with brilliant new ideas. By participating in this category, you develop an understanding of what your own future endeavors may look like in terms of defining the world through innovation and discovery. In the end, NRD sets you up to turn curiosity into action that matters, enabling you to imagine, and even build, tomorrow's breakthroughs. Let this be the next "Eureka" moment.

Round 1

ROUND DURATION: 1 HOURS

DELEGATE CAP: 3

This MCQ round will assess delegates' experimental, theoretical, and data-analysis skills through research-based questions. The questions will test their ability to interpret experimental setups, identify appropriate methodologies and variables, analyse and interpret data, evaluate results, and apply relevant scientific concepts. The round will consist of three sets of MCQs: Easy, Medium, and Hard. After completing each set, one delegate from each team will leave the room, with the delegates leaving after the Easy and Medium sets. By the final Hard set, only one delegate from each team will remain in the room, and they will be solely responsible for solving the final set of questions. This structure will test both the individual research skills of delegates and their ability to perform under increasing difficulty and limited collaboration.

****This is an elimination round****

Round 2

ROUND DURATION: 2 HOURS

DELEGATE CAP: 1-2

Roughly 10 teams will proceed to Round 2.

For Round 2, delegates will step into the shoes of iconic historical scientists, such as Albert Einstein or Marie Curie, who have been brought into the 21st century. To maintain strict fairness and test true on-the-spot reasoning, delegates will not be allowed to use phones or internet access. The research topics will be disclosed on the spot, alongside a provided dossier of factual data outlining arguments both for and against the issue. Delegates will either speak in favor of or against the topic, framing their arguments through the lens of their assigned scientist's perspective and philosophy. The round will run in a fast-paced MUN style, with each delegate delivering a 2 to 3 minute formal speech. Halfway through the session, the judges will introduce a live crisis update or new piece of scientific evidence. Delegates must immediately adapt to this new information in their subsequent speeches while maintaining their scientist's persona and chosen stance. This round assesses delegates on their historical roleplay, critical data synthesis, public speaking under MUN-style rules, and agility when handling unexpected crisis updates.

**** This will be an elimination round****

Round 3

DELEGATE CAP: 3-5

ROUND DURATION: 2.5 HOURS

The three highest-scoring teams will qualify for the final round. The team with the highest cumulative score will get the first choice from three problem statements provided by the organisers. The second-highest-scoring team will then select from the remaining two problem statements. The final qualifying team will be assigned the remaining problem statement. Once the problem statements have been selected, each team will conduct a practical experiment based on their assigned problem.

Teams will be expected to:

- Develop a suitable hypothesis
- Design and conduct an appropriate experiment
- Establish a suitable control experiment
- Collect and recall relevant data
- Draw a conclusion and prepare a presentation on their findings

Teams will then present their research and findings to a panel of judges. The presentation should clearly communicate the team's approach to the problem, experimental setup, hypothesis, data, analysis, and conclusion.

Note: The proceedings of each round may be changed at the sole discretion of the category heads.